

TOME VI

The Withdrawal

Nabek — Off the Ship

August 5, 2026

Act of restoration, choice of conscience, legitimacy of the soil

SIXTH PART

The Withdrawal of Consent — Act, Not Posture

In 2022, I renounced the institution. This is not a sentence one writes lightly. This is not a theatrical gesture. It is an act. An act of restoration. An act of memory. An act of life. An act of —

I am not in revolt. Revolt is still playing the adversary's game. It is still recognizing that his rule has validity. It is still asking the machine to change gears. I no longer play. I rise from the table. I return the cards. I leave the casino. I get off the —

The withdrawal of consent is not a posture. It is an end. It is choosing one's destiny. It is taking oneself in hand. It is not saying "I disagree" while continuing to pay. It is not sharing articles on social media while going to vote. It is not criticizing the government while sending it your taxes. It is ceasing to pay. It is ceasing to present oneself. It is ceasing to answer to the register name. It is ceasing to feed the —

When I say that I am free, it is not a slogan. It is not a flag. It is not a hashtag. It is an observation. The bird is free. The tree is free. The river is free. They need no permission. They need no number. They need no representative. They *are*. And their freedom is not a right that has been granted to them. It is their condition. It is their nature. It is their —

I too, *am*. I was born of my mother. Not of an administrative act. I bear the name that life gave me, not the number that the register stuck on me. I walk upon this land because the land carries me, not because a deed of ownership authorizes me to. I breathe because the air is there, not because a decree permits me to —

THE LEGITIMACY I GIVE MYSELF

I am often asked: but who recognizes you? By what authority do you speak? What tribunal has ruled in your favour? What deputy has mandated you? What journalist has interviewed you? And I answer: by the authority of breath. By the authority of the earth. By the authority of my ancestors who walked before me and of my descendants who will walk after. By the authority of the Wampum that has never been broken. By the authority of the river that flows without —

I do not seek the recognition of an enslaving, genocidal institution. I do not seek to be recognized by a State that sees in me only a victim to pity, a citizen to control, a number to tax. My legitimacy does not come from its laws, its tribunals, its subsidies. It comes from the soil, from the river, from the Living. It comes from memory. It comes from relationship. It comes from —

It is a position of resistance, of clarity, of presence. I refuse the embarkation of the colonial ship, this vessel of death that advances by crushing bodies, memories, territories. I refuse the spiral that swallows. I refuse the sacrifice they ask me to make on the altar of the economy. I refuse to give my body, my time, my thoughts, my children to a machine without —

Legitimacy, I give it to myself. I do not wait for it from above. I do not wait for it from a judge, a deputy, a journalist, a professor. I take it. I bear it. I live it. Every morning when I rise, every step I place upon unceded land, every word I pronounce without asking permission, every breath I take without paying —

ACTING IN FULL CONSCIOUSNESS

I do not act under constraint. I do not act out of despair. I do not act out of anger, even if the anger is just. I act in full consciousness. It is a free choice. Despite external constraints. Because there are some. The institution will not let itself disappear. It will never acknowledge its wrongs. It is designed to take from the earth to all souls, as it calls us. It practices —

But it has a weakness. Only one. It needs us. Without our bodies, it does not run. Without our fear, it does not reign. Without our consent, even tacit, even asleep, it does not exist. It is a timeless entity that mutates to adapt and take. But if we cease to give it to take, it dries up. Like a mycelium without a tree to parasitize. Like a ship without sailors to row. Like a fire without —

I no longer feed it. I no longer give it my time. I no longer give it my name. I no longer give it my fear. I no longer give it my children. I no longer give it my —

It is a free choice. Despite external constraints. Because there are some. The police may strike. The judge may speak. The bailiff may paste. But they cannot force me to believe. They cannot force me to consent. They cannot force me to forget. Memory is the last fortress. And it is —

Nabek — Off the Ship — Island of the Turtle — Year 410 of the 1616 Treaty

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